

Evan Dower, Staff Software Engineer

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Location: Remote/Seattle, WA, USA

Visa Status: Seeking sponsorship for relocation to Australia or New Zealand

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Professional Summary

- Staff frontend platform engineer with 20+ years at Indeed and Amazon, specializing in web performance, micro-frontend architecture, and developer infrastructure at scale
- Delivers incrementally, using data and A/B tests to decide whether further investment makes business sense
- Applies AI-assisted engineering in practice, from LLM-driven migration codemods to an internal AI tool used by 390+ employees

Skills

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, React Native, React Strict DOM, Node.js, Java, Spring, Spark (Scala)

Platform & Practices: Micro-frontends, Webpack Module Federation, Web Performance, A/B Testing, CI/CD, Envoy, Terraform, Datadog, Playwright, Cypress, LLM Agent Harnesses, AI-Authored Codemods

Experience

Indeed, Seattle, WA

Moved from individual contributor to engineering manager (6 engineers) and back to IC by choice, for hands-on platform work.

Staff Software Engineer (Frontend Platforms) - April 2019 to present

Platform Development & Architecture:

- built & productionized micro-frontend framework, decoupling hundreds of content provider teams & dozens of consuming webapp teams to enable rapid, independent iteration
- owned the global navigation header and footer served across nearly all Indeed pages (2.2B+ requests per week), and designed JavaScript dependency sharing across decoupled components with webpack module federation, becoming one of Indeed's few subject matter experts in the technology (including [fixing bugs in webpack itself](#))
- led cross-platform validation of React Strict DOM, a top strategic priority for the mobile app platform organization, across four web and mobile teams; a 50/50 A/B test on web, Android, and iOS showed ~20% better web performance with neutral business metrics, and the codemod keeps migration ready while adoption is paused for upstream maturity
- pioneered an AI-driven migration method: built an iterative LLM agent harness that took the migration codemod from 515 errors to 0 and cut its runtime from 420 to 60 seconds, so the entire React Native codebase could be transformed on every build and A/B tested without halting product development

Performance & Optimization:

- designed and shipped a server-side rendering worker pool for the global navigation and job seeker web services, increasing the share of search-results page users experiencing good site speed by 18%, contributing a 4% improvement to the organization's site-speed objective, and cutting running instances by 35% (~\$115K projected annual savings)
- delivered 8% Homepage performance improvement through GraphQL bundle optimization and dependency upgrades, giving a priority-1 design system upgrade the margin it needed for a neutral A/B result and approval, recognized at the VP level
- delivered shared-dependency event loop optimization achieving 0.68% worldwide site speed improvement, resulting in 0.34% more Homepage job clicks and 0.31% more total job applications
- unblocked a major web app's React 19 release by tracing regressions to the React streaming server renderer's chunk-size setting, and separately cut desktop search-results page latency by 13-21%
- eliminated recurring latency alerts for the global navigation service (32 triggers to zero) by tracing slow requests to bad hosts, right-sizing workers and CPU, bounding queue admission, moving retries to the Envoy service mesh, and enabling request hedging, cutting p95 latency in one data center from 30 ms to 12.5 ms
- reduced the global navigation header's initial bundle size by 48% and its mobile payload by 84%
- added parallel S3 uploads to company-wide shared CI templates, cutting merge-request pipelines from ~11.5 to ~1.5 minutes

Technical Leadership & Problem Solving:

- named site speed technical lead for the job seeker product organization, recognized for establishing the metrics and improvements that enabled goal attainment; earlier authored the site speed opportunities analysis that formed its roadmap
- architected design system upgrade infrastructure (dual-building and A/B testing across product surfaces) and led the React 18, design system v6, and design system v7 upgrades for job seeker surfaces; for the priority-1 v7 upgrade, root-caused conflicting micro-frontend providers overriding design tokens and held measured site-speed impact to ~2% vs. a projected 30%
- hardened release safety for the shared JavaScript dependency platform after an upgrade caused a global navigation footer outage, adding A/B release slots, release-candidate CI, cross-version smoke tests, and feature-flag rollback
- set and later updated the job seeker browser support policy with product and design, retiring fragile polyfills, then handed it to the design system team

Cross-Organizational Impact:

- pioneered AI-driven developer productivity through TEA (Talent Enablement Automation), growing a self-initiated hackathon project into an evidence-grounded performance-review tool used by 390+ employees across engineering, technical delivery, and science roles, including 40+ people managers, with 210+ returning users and extensions merged by six other engineers
- served as go-to technical lead for global navigation and micro-frontend integration across identity, authentication, employer, international, and mobile teams, and represented the team in a cross-team tech leads forum

Mentorship & Community:

- mentored engineers across teams on flame-graph analysis, performance triage, debugging, and breaking work into incremental, risk-reducing deliverables, including mentoring an engineer through a transition into software engineering
- mentored engineers as an AI Champion on AI tooling workflows, MCP server configuration, and prompt engineering, and published engineering blog posts on AI-assisted writing and faster CI pipelines
- guided 100+ external contributors to the global navigation platform through code reviews and technical direction

Earlier Indeed Roles (Hiring Products) - August 2015 to March 2019

Software Engineer → Tech Lead → Technical Delivery Manager, on job-applicant screening products

- managed performance & development of 6 software engineers, coordinating with design, QA, data science, and 2 PMs
- increased jobs with screener questions in Italy, Spain & France by 68% (from 44% to 74%) while maintaining >60% acceptance
- increased suggested question acceptance from 25% to 43% (18% to 32% outside the US), reaching ~1.3M accepted in Q4 2016
- delivered high-utility question identification, increasing employer positive response rate by 8%
- maintained 5 9's uptime on ~1.5B calls and designed a client-focused, data-driven API decoupling client & service changes

Amazon, Seattle, WA

A decade building full-stack developer infrastructure used by >10k Amazon engineers.

Software Development Engineer (Developer Tools; earlier, Ordering) - March 2005 to July 2015

- **Cost Optimization:** Improved deployment scheduling from $O(n^3)$ to $O(n^2)$, letting Amazon scale deployments for Q4 loads
- **Distributed Systems:** Helped build highly available, horizontally scalable revision control for >300k Git repositories
- **Process Automation:** Led a team building company-wide continuous deployment, automating ~40k release processes
- **Vendor Cost Reduction:** Owned internal revision control systems with monitoring, throttling, and hot standby capabilities, enabling Amazon to terminate Perforce support contract and save ~\$1M annually
- **Developer Tools:** Owned multiple generations of internal code review systems (~6k reviews per day, >10k users) and helped build an internal "GitHub for Amazon"
- **Ordering:** Owned the marketplace seller order management system used by all Amazon sellers (2005-2006)

Education

B.S., Computer Science, University of Washington, Seattle (2001 - 2005)